much as possible. Tough times call for innovation and with oxygen still falling short in several places, he asked if nitrogen plants could be converted to oxygen plants. He was informed that the only difference in the process of producing nitrogen and oxygen is the use of carbon molecular sieve (CMS) which would need to be replaced by zeolite molecular sieve (ZMS) along with some other doable tweaks. As per his usual style, the prime minister reached out to industry associations which identified about 37 nitrogen plants that could be converted to produce oxygen in a short time span.[32] On 18 April, following directives of the PM, the Union Home Secretary issued an advisory to states and UTs to take necessary measures to prohibit the supply of oxygen for industrial purposes in view of the surge in cases.[33]

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In yet another high-level meeting on 17 April, attended by Principal Secretary Dr Mishra, Secretaries of Home, Health and Pharmaceuticals and Dr Paul, the prime minister explicitly instructed that the entire national capacity must be utilized to ramp up vaccine production since collective vaccination was really the only way to emerge from the pandemic. He wanted an update on the status of the production augmentation of remdesivir and other medicines which were needed. While the GoI had already made efforts to increase remdesivir production from 27 lakh vials in January 2021 to an expected output of 74 lakh per month in May 2021, the prime minister insisted that the full potential of the pharmaceutical industry should be used to meet the rising demands of the hour of crisis. However, he advised that caution must be exercised while prescribing remdesivir and other medicines and the team must ensure that they are prescribed under approved medical guidelines. He was also of the opinion that a strict watch should be kept on their misuse and black marketing. Equally aware that hospitals were becoming overburdened, the prime minister directed that additional beds, temporary hospitals and isolation centres must be built on a war footing. Based on his instructions during the first wave, the DRDO had built a 500-bedded Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel COVID-19 Hospital in Delhi in a record time of 12 days. The facility had been restarted. Due to his intervention, in Lucknow too, a 600-bedded hospital was built in a matter of weeks by the DRDO. Similarly in Gujarat, a 900-bedded facility and in